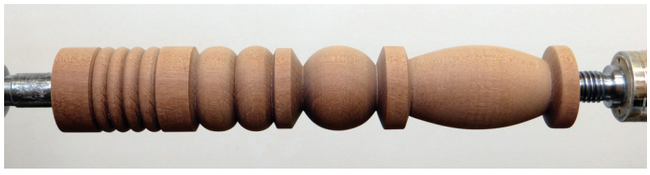
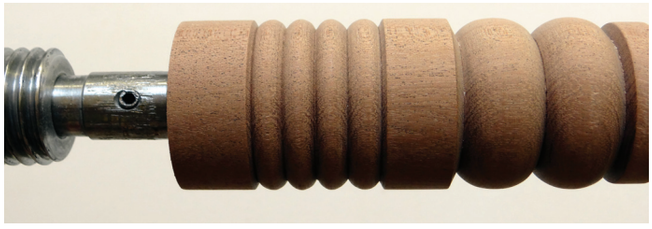
Positive shapes

So a bead is a bead, right? Well not quite, because if it's a narrow bead it is known as a ring, and if it's stretched out it can become a bobbin or a sausage. This is illustrated in the pictures here.

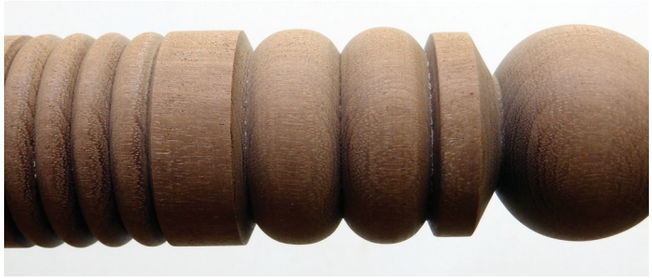
A bead will tend to be slightly narrower than it is tall. When a bead becomes very small and narrow it becomes known as a ring. This is not to be confused with a captive ring, which is parted from the main section of timber, and is free to rattle and move around. As a bead gets wider it will reach a point where it clearly becomes a ball, and everyone knows what a ball looks like! Once it is stretched further still it becomes known as a bobbin. Continuing to stretch it to the point where it has a straight face with rounded ends, it becomes a sausage.



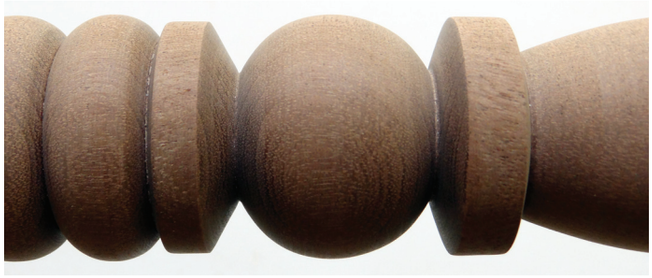
Different positive turned shapes



Rings



Beads

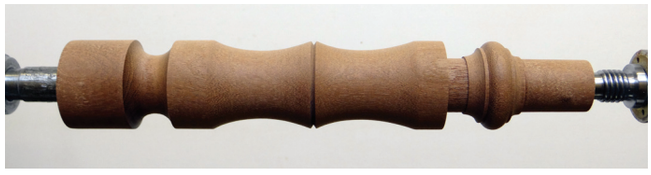


A ball

A bobbin

Negative shapes

You will be seeing by now that by altering a shape, it often gets a new name or description and while there are fewer variations for hollow shapes, there are still distinct differences. 'Cove' is the most common phrase used for these hollow shapes, much like 'bead' is the common name for rounded shapes. Coves can be almost any size and are called coves until they are stretched out to form a long hollow, which is known as a reel. In the image you will see two reels separated by a quirk, which I will come to later. A scotia is best described as a lopsided cove. A cavetto is a half cove, often seen with a small fillet either side of it, where a central bead has a fillet each side, followed by a cavetto and another fillet, before continuing along the spindle.



Different negative curves

A cove

Reels – separated by a quirk

Cavettos, each side of a bead, using fillets to break up and define the details

The oak jewellery box featured in one of my earlier series uses a combination of the cavetto and bead

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